bridges, crossing equipment, and mobile antiaircraft vehicles was probably related to the changes that the Egyptians put into the war plan, namely, the increase of crossing forces in the first phase of the war from three divisions to five. The equipment and armaments included in the agreement were supplied with unprecedented speed, with most of them reaching Egypt in April–May 1973. In May or June of 1973, the Soviets also supplied Egypt with Scud ground-to- ground missiles.

- Two additional insights to help understand the entire picture. The first is that while Sadat was prodding the Soviets to expand the supply of offensive weapons, the Russians were preparing for the second summit meeting in July 1973 in Washington. It would be fair to assume that the Russians restricted the types of equipment they provided to Egypt before the summit, and there was indeed evidence of this in the Mossad's intelligence material. According to one source, in a meeting between Sadat and Brezhnev the latter told Sadat explicitly that only if the summit did not produce satisfactory diplomatic results with regard to the Egyptian-Israeli conflict would he supply Egypt with the offensive weapons it needed. The summit did indeed end in failure when it came to this issue. Even so, at the end of the day it appears that the Soviets did not satisfy all the Egyptians' desires. Evidence of this is Sadat's agreements with Libya that it would provide Egypt with two Mirage squadrons, with Saudi Arabia and Kuwait that they would provide squadrons and "Lightning" aircraft, and with Iraq that they would provide a "Hunter" squadron. In the area of electronic warfare as well, the Egyptians did not settle for what the Soviets supplied them, and in March 1973 they purchased electronic warfare equipment from French and British companies. And as early as mid-1972, the Egyptians purchased water pumps from British and German companies for the purpose of breaking through the ramparts on either side of the Canal.
- The second insight relates to the dates of the war. Reading the enormous amount of intelligence material about the Egyptian- Russian negotiations on the supply of weapons, the signing of contracts, the supply times, and so on, it is clear why the first date set for the launch of the war—late 1972 to early 1973—was postponed until the late April–early June 1973, and why this date was in turn postponed to the